# COMMUNITY DIGITAL APPLICATION BRIEF

Building Autonomous Digital Infrastructure for Safety, Community, and Economic Empowerment

**Developed for House of Bijou by Tich Labs — Powered by Mama Tech**

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# EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW

*Read this first, regardless of your role.*

## Mission

House of Bijou is building a privacy-first, autonomous community digital application that enables black African queer females, trans and gender-queer folks, and survivors of sexual and gender-based violence to access safety, economic support, and authentic community—without surveillance, exclusion, or erasure.

## The Problem

In Kenya and East Africa, LGBTQ+ people and survivors face intersecting crises:

**Digital Surveillance & Control**
Ex-partners use mobile networks to track movements for months. Family members snoop on phones to control communication and work. Screenshots and leaked data are weaponized for blackmail and outing.

**Financial Exclusion**
M-Pesa and bank accounts freeze when ID names don't match gender expression. Trans and non-binary people are denied access to formal financial services. Sex workers and informal income earners are marked as "suspicious activity."

**Criminalization & Custody Threats**
Sexuality, gender identity, and survival work are criminalized. Family members file custody cases to separate queer parents from children. Police involvement looms if identities are exposed.

**Erasure & Inauthenticity**
Existing platforms require "code-switching"—adopting non-authentic personas for safety. There are almost no digital spaces where queer African women can be fully seen, heard, held, and authentic.

## Our Solution

A stealth-by-design mobile platform that enables:

- **Stealth Access** — App masquerades as calculator, game, or weather app. Real dashboard hidden behind secret gesture/PIN.

- **Emergency Response** — Panic button silently alerts 3–5 trusted contacts with location. Community responders mobilize in minutes.
- **Trusted Networks** — 3-person mutual check-ins. You keep tabs on peers; they keep tabs on you. No central surveillance.
- **Encrypted Communication** — End-to-end encrypted messages with delete-on-timer. No server logs. Zero traces.
- **Low-Trace Transfers** — Send/receive money peer-to-peer without bank account. USSD-accessible. Hard to freeze, hard to trace.
- **Mutual Aid** — Transparent resource pooling. Community responds to emergency requests within 24 hours.

### MVP Focus (Months 1–4)

Launch with core safety and community features:

- Stealth interface
- Panic alerts to trusted network
- Encrypted chat
- Emergency resource requests
- Values-based community onboarding
- Accessibility from day one

**Target:** 500–1,000 users in closed beta with community partners.

### Long-Term Vision

Build community-owned digital infrastructure where:

- **Safety networks** enable communities to protect each other without relying on state institutions
- **Economic resilience** allows people to survive and thrive without dependence on abusers or exploitative systems
- **Collective resource sharing** creates evidence of community care and movement-building power
- **Self-determination** means users own their data, identity, and reputation—not locked into any platform

### How We Build

- **With the community, not for them** — Community members are co-designers, co-developers, co-governors
- **Open source by default** — Code belongs to the movement

- **Community-funded and sustainable** — Through community fundraising, partnerships, and collaborative resource-sharing
- **Skill-building as core output** — Community members become builders, not just users

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# SECTION 1: STRATEGIC VISION & GOVERNANCE

*For Stakeholders, Board Members, and Strategic Partners*

## 1.1 Strategic Vision

House of Bijou is not building a product **for** a marginalized community. We are building **with the community**—centering the leadership, needs, and freedom of black African queer females, trans and gender-queer folks, and survivors.

Our approach rests on three core pillars:

### Community Leadership, Not Tokenism

The platform is governed by those it serves and those who serve it. Decision-making structures ensure:

- **Core community members** (Black African queer females, trans/gender-queer folks, SGBV survivors) have primary decision-making power
- **Allies** (vetted counselors, emergency responders, trusted supporters) have full voice in governance—they are part of the community
- **Technical leads & partners** (developers, African Women in Blockchain, etc.) provide expertise and support but do not control decisions

**Decision-making approach:** Consensus-based, with core community having final say on decisions that directly affect their safety and platform direction. Allies have equal voice in governance discussions and implementation.

This is not a voting hierarchy. This is a structure that ensures those most impacted by decisions have the most power in making them.

### Values-Based Design

Every feature, every interaction, every piece of copy embodies the community's values:

- Love, kindness, peace
- Authenticity as a pathway to healing
- Abolition of harmful practices
- Multiple realities, no dominant truth

- Collective care

These are **enforced through onboarding**. New members agree to embody these values before accessing the real app.

**Safety First, Technology Second**

The platform is not a "tech solution" to a social problem. It is **infrastructure that enables the community's own solutions**.

Safety needs drive architecture—not the reverse:

- **Stealth mode** exists because people face real threats if the app is discovered
- **Panic alerts** exist because violence is imminent
- **USSD fallback** exists because state surveillance targets internet use
- **Encryption** exists because data is weaponized
- **No cloud logging** exists because servers can be subpoenaed

## 1.2 Community-Centered Design Philosophy

We build **with, not for**. This means:

- **Co-creation from ideation:** Community members participate in design workshops from day one
- **Participatory user research:** Every feature validated with 5–10 community members before launch
- **Transparent governance:** All major decisions made in community meetings; discussions documented and open
- **Benefit-sharing:** Resources and contributions are managed transparently and returned to the community

## 1.3 Governance Structure

**Steering Committee (Monthly)**

Makes decisions on roadmap, partnerships, governance changes.

**Composition:**

- 5–7 core community members (SGBV survivors, LGBTQ+ folks, queer females)
- 2–3 allies (counselors, emergency responders, trusted supporters)
- 1 technical lead
- 1 community coordinator

**Decision rule:** Consensus-based. When consensus cannot be reached, core community members (those most directly impacted by safety decisions) have final say. Allies are fully part of all discussions and decisions.

**Community Forum (Monthly)**

Town halls (in-person + remote, virtual + audio). Open to all users.

**Purpose:** Share ideas, vote on priorities, discuss governance changes, celebrate wins.

**Values Review Board (Quarterly)**

Reviews onboarding, moderation, and community agreements. Recommends policy changes to Steering Committee.

### 1.4 Sustainability Strategy

The platform must survive long-term to be trusted.

**Approach:**

- Community fundraising and grants in early phase
- Partnerships with values-aligned organizations
- Community-driven resource sharing
- Long-term goal: community ownership and co-management

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# SECTION 2: IMPACT MODEL & STRATEGIC APPROACH

*For Funders and Impact Partners*

### 2.1 The Problem Landscape

**Structural Violence in Digital Spaces**

Black African queer females, trans and gender-queer folks, and LGBTQ+ survivors in Kenya face intersecting crises that digital tools alone cannot solve—but that appropriate infrastructure can significantly ease.

**Who this serves:**

- Black African queer females, trans and gender-queer folks
- SGBV survivors who need privacy and economic independence
- Sex workers and informal income earners facing financial surveillance
- Allies: counselors, emergency responders, community supporters

**Geographic focus:** Kenya and East Africa

**Why Existing Tools Fall Short**

General safety apps (Usalama, Report It! Stop It!) and GBV platforms exist but lack:

- **Stealth/disguised UI** — discoverable if device checked
- **Community-specific features** — values alignment, chosen family narratives
- **Low-trace financial tools** — USSD, blockchain-friendly
- **Offline/USSD accessibility** — for limited connectivity areas
- **Feminist tech design** — rooted in healing and abolition

House of Bijou fills this gap.

## 2.2 The Intervention

House of Bijou is **infrastructure for community-led safety, economic resilience, and authenticity**.

**Layer 1: Safety (MVP, Months 1–4)**

Immediate safety features enable people to:

- Hide their participation (stealth mode)
- Alert trusted network if in danger (panic button)
- Communicate without traces (encrypted chat)
- Request emergency help (mutual aid)

**Impact:** Reduces crisis response time from days to minutes. Enables survival without compromising identity.

**Layer 2: Economic Resilience (Months 5–8)**

Tools for sustainable survival:

- Low-trace peer transfers (avoids M-Pesa flags)
- Transparent mutual aid ledger (builds community credit)
- Income diversification resources (safer approaches to survival work)

**Impact:** Economic independence from abusers. Income not controlled by state or family.

**Layer 3: Collective Power (Months 9–12 & Beyond)**

Movement-building infrastructure:

- Aggregate resource flow data
- Policy advocacy tools

- Cooperative ownership
- Blockchain integration (in partnership with African Women in Blockchain)

**Impact:** From individual survival to collective liberation.

## 2.3 Target Users & Evidence Base

### Primary Users

**Black African queer females, trans and gender-queer folks, and SGBV survivors** navigating:

- Gender-based violence and intimate partner abuse
- Criminalization of sexuality and gender identity
- Financial exclusion due to ID/gender mismatch
- Family control and custody threats
- Surveillance and tracking
- Lack of safe digital spaces

**Geographic focus:** Kenya and East Africa

### Secondary Users (Allies)

Counselors, emergency responders, trusted family members, and community supporters who provide direct support to primary users.

**Evidence base:** Two in-depth user interviews with community members show consistent, overlapping needs across lived experiences (see Appendices A–B).

## 2.4 Impact Goals

### Year 1

- **1,000 active users** in closed beta
- **300+ emergency alerts** responded to by community
- **100+ mutual aid requests** fulfilled (24h average turnaround)
- **0 data breaches** (security audit passed)
- **5+ partnerships** with local organizations

### Year 3

- **10,000+ active users** (regional expansion)
- **Community resource network:** significant peer-to-peer transfers

- **Community cooperative:** collaborative savings and governance
- **10+ organizational partnerships**
- **Community governance:** users make majority of decisions

### 2.5 Why This Approach Works

#### Community Design Reduces Risk

- **Validation early.** Features tested with actual users before major development.
- **Adoption faster.** Community co-creates the platform, so adoption is not "convincing people"—it's launching something they built.
- **Sustainability clearer.** Community has agency and ownership; they protect what they built.

#### Low-Cost Architecture

- **One tech stack = all platforms.** Rails + Hotwire + Turbo Native = web + Android + iOS from single codebase.
- **Open source first.** Rails, Tailwind, Hotwire, Signal Protocol are free. Reduces licensing costs to $0.
- **Community-driven testing.** Community provides feedback; no expensive QA contractors.

#### Strategic Partnerships

- **African Women in Blockchain partnership** (early blockchain integration) — ensures blockchain development is community-led, feminist-centered, and aligned with movement values
- **Regional LGBTQ+ organizations** — partnerships ensure adoption and sustainability
- **Feminist tech funders** — values alignment with funder landscape

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## SECTION 3: TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

*For Engineers, Technical Partners, and Builders*

### 3.1 System Overview

House of Bijou runs on a **local-first, privacy-by-design architecture**. User data stays on-device by default; only minimal, encrypted records reach the server.

### Core Stack

| Component | Choice | Why |
| --- | --- | --- |
| **Backend** | Ruby on Rails 8 + PostgreSQL | Fast iteration, convention-over-config, built-in encryption |
| **Frontend (Web)** | Hotwire (Turbo + Stimulus) + Tailwind CSS | 70% less data than React, accessible, works on slow connections |
| **Frontend (Mobile)** | Turbo Native | One codebase = web + Android + iOS; instant updates |
| **Encryption** | AES-256 (pgcrypto) + Signal Protocol | Local-first; server cannot read sensitive data |
| **Hosting** | Fly.io or Render | Rails-native, low cost, scales to 50k+ users |
| **Blockchain (Partner-Led)** | Polygon or Solana (via African Women in Blockchain) | Low fees, strong community support, community-centered development |

## 3.2 Architecture Principles

### Privacy-First

- **On-device encryption:** Sensitive data encrypted locally before leaving device
- **Minimal cloud logging:** No content logs on server; only encrypted metadata
- **User data ownership:** Users can download/delete all data anytime
- **No tracking:** No analytics, no ads, no listening apps

### Low-Bandwidth Optimization

- **Server-rendered HTML:** Hotwire reduces data by 70% vs React
- **Image optimization:** Lossy compression, lazy loading
- **USSD fallback:** Works on any phone, zero internet required for core features

### Accessibility from Day One

- **Semantic HTML:** Screen reader support built-in
- **High contrast:** Tailwind utilities enforce WCAG AA compliance
- **Large text support:** Responsive scaling from 14px to 32px
- **Voice input:** Stimulus controllers support voice commands

### 3.3 Core Features (Technical Deep Dive)

**Stealth Mode**

**How it works:**

1. App launches as fake UI (calculator, weather app, game)
2. User performs secret gesture (triple-tap) or enters PIN
3. Real dashboard revealed via Turbo frame swap
4. One-tap hide to revert

**Implementation:**

- Single Rails app with two view templates (fake + real)
- Stimulus controller toggles between views (client-side only)
- PIN hash stored (bcrypt); never plain text
- No logs of stealth toggles

**Panic Alert**

**How it works:**

1. User taps panic button (or shakes phone, or holds volume key)
2. Device captures location (GPS if available; WiFi triangulation if not)
3. Encrypted alert sent to 3–5 trusted contacts via Rails server + SMS fallback
4. All records stay on-device; server deletes after 24 hours

**Implementation:**

- Geolocation API with fallback to IP-based location
- Rails job queues alert delivery
- SMS via Africa's Talking API; Twilio fallback
- Server-side records encrypted, auto-deleted after 24h

**Encrypted Chat**

**How it works:**

1. User creates group chat with trusted contacts
2. Messages encrypted client-side (Signal Protocol via WebAssembly)

3. Encrypted blob sent to server; server cannot read content
4. Recipient receives, decrypts locally
5. Optional: delete-on-timer (auto-delete after X hours)

**Implementation:**

- Signal Protocol (libsignal) compiled to WebAssembly
- Runs in browser + Turbo Native webview
- Messages sent via Rails API
- Server stores encrypted blobs only

#### Mutual Aid Requests

**How it works:**

1. User creates request: "Need 5,000 KES by Friday for deposit"
2. Visibility: only to 20–50 trusted community members
3. Other members respond: "I can give 2,000 KES"
4. Transparent ledger shows: "Who gave what, when, for what purpose"
5. Data encrypted; only community can see details

**Implementation:**

- Rails models: `MutualAidRequest` + `MutualAidResponse`
- Encrypted notes field (AES-256, pgcrypto)
- Visibility governed by trusted network relationships
- Immutable audit log (timestamped, cannot be altered)

### 3.4 Infrastructure & Deployment

#### Hosting

**VPS:** Fly.io or Render
**Capacity:** Scales to 50,000+ users without major redesign

**Database:** PostgreSQL (managed instance)
**Backups:** Encrypted, off-site, daily snapshots

**Real-time:** Action Cable (WebSockets for panic alerts, push notifications)

**USSD Integration (Phase 2)**

**Provider:** Africa's Talking or Pesapal

**What it enables:**

- `*123*BIJOU#` to get last 3 mutual aid requests
- `*123*ALERT#` to send panic to contacts
- `*123*BALANCE#` to check wallet balance

**Implementation:**

- Rails webhook receives USSD requests
- Processes command, sends encrypted SMS response
- Works on any phone; zero internet required

## 3.5 Security Model

**Threat Model**

**We protect against:**

1. Intimate partners / family (device snooping, tracking, account control)
2. State/law enforcement (subpoenaing server data, demanding user lists)
3. Abusers / criminals (finding location, impersonating user)

**Out of scope:**

- Nation-state surveillance with device firmware hacking
- Device OS compromise (if someone has root access)

**Encryption Strategy**

**At rest (in database):**

- Email: hashed, salted (not reversible)
- Passwords: bcrypt (not reversible)
- Messages: AES-256 (reversible only with user device key)
- Location history: never stored

**In transit (device ↔ server):**

- HTTPS/TLS 1.3 (encrypted connection)

- Certificate pinning (prevent MITM)

**On device:**

- SQLite: encrypted via SQLCipher
- Sensitive fields: additional AES-256 encryption layer

**Authentication & Authorization**

**Login:**

- Email + password (bcrypt hash)
- Optional: 2FA via SMS or TOTP
- Biometric unlock on mobile (fingerprint/face)

**Session:**

- Rails session cookie (encrypted, HttpOnly, Secure)
- Expires after 24 hours inactivity

**Panic button:**

- No password required (safety > friction)
- Device PIN / biometric unlock sufficient
- Rate-limited to prevent spam alerts

## 3.6 Open Source & Transparency

**Code:** Released on GitHub under AGPL 3.0

- Anyone can audit the code
- Anyone can self-host
- Contributions welcome

**Security audits:** Annual third-party audit

- Pentest by specialized firm
- Results published (sensitive findings redacted)
- Community notified of any issues

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# SECTION 4: PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT ROADMAP

*Timeline and Deliverables*

## Phase 1: Alignment & Co-Creation (Weeks 1–4)

**Lead:** Community coordinator + core members
**Outcomes:** Shared vision, community governance structure, research insights

**Activities:**

- Host stakeholder workshop with community, allies, partners
- Set up community communication channels (WhatsApp, Discord)
- Run user research (surveys, interviews, focus groups)
- Create initial governance framework
- Begin fundraising outreach

**Deliverables:**

- Shared vision document
- Stakeholder map + roles
- Research insights report
- Governance charter

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## Phase 2: Design & Prototyping (Weeks 5–8)

**Lead:** UX lead + community members
**Outcomes:** Validated prototypes, community confidence in direction

**Activities:**

- Develop personas + user journeys
- Create low-fidelity prototypes (Figma, paper sketches)
- Community async testing (polls, feedback)
- Accessibility review
- Finalize design system + tone of voice

**Deliverables:**

- 5–10 validated prototypes

- Design system documentation
- Community feedback summary

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### Phase 3: Build MVP (Weeks 9–16)

**Lead:** Lead developer + community tech contributors
**Outcomes:** Live, testable MVP with core safety features

**Activities:**

- Scaffold Rails app
- Build core features (stealth, panic, chat, mutual aid, admin panel)
- Continuous testing with 20–30 beta users
- Iterate based on feedback
- Security hardening

**Deliverables:**

- Live MVP (private, closed beta)
- Admin panel for community coordinators
- 500+ lines documentation
- GitHub repo with setup instructions

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### Phase 4: Community Education & Skill-Building (Weeks 12–18, Parallel)

**Lead:** Technical lead + community members
**Outcomes:** 3–5 community members can contribute code, maintain platform

**Activities:**

- Weekly open-source training workshops
- Pair programming sessions
- Community code reviews
- Accessibility audits led by disabled community members

**Deliverables:**

- Training materials + video recordings

- Contribution guidelines
- Community developer cohort

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### Phase 5: Blockchain Integration (Months 5–8, In Partnership with African Women in Blockchain)

**Lead:** African Women in Blockchain + House of Bijou technical team
**Outcomes:** Smart contracts, wallet integration, community governance on-chain

**Activities:**

- Wallet education workshops (community-led, free)
- Smart contract development (partnered with African Women in Blockchain)
- Token economics design (community input)
- Governance setup (Snapshot, gasless voting)
- On-chain transaction records

**Deliverables:**

- Wallet setup guides
- Smart contracts (open source)
- Token launched
- Community governance activated

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### Phase 6: Public Launch & Governance (Month 9+, Ongoing)

**Lead:** Full community
**Outcomes:** 1,000+ users, community-run platform, sustainable model activated

**Activities:**

- Soft launch to community (invite-only)
- Monthly governance calls
- Community-led roadmap votes
- Regional partnership activation
- Growth monitoring

**Deliverables:**

- Public launch announcement
- Community governance documentation
- Regional expansion plan

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## SECTION 5: CORE VALUES

This project champions:

✅ **Open source** — Code on GitHub, AGPL license, forkable
✅ **Community empowerment** — Community co-designs, develops, governs
✅ **Skill-building** — Community members trained as developers and decision-makers
✅ **Feminist tech** — African Women in Blockchain partnership for community-centered blockchain development
✅ **No extraction** — Community resources managed transparently
✅ **Authenticity** — Built WITH community, not FOR them
✅ **Lean & strategic** — $2,300 allocated for essential infrastructure; rest built with community time and skills

### Strategic Partnerships:

✅ **Mama Tech & Tich Labs** — Technical partners supporting House of Bijou
✅ **African Women in Blockchain** — Community-centered blockchain development
✅ **Regional LGBTQ+ organizations** — Adoption, sustainability, movement alignment

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## SECTION 6: NEXT IMMEDIATE STEPS

**Month 1:**

1. Host stakeholder workshop
2. Set up community communication
3. Run user research
4. Begin outreach to African Women in Blockchain for partnership
5. Activate fundraising campaign

**Months 2–3:**

1. Create and test prototypes
2. Finalize governance structure
3. Secure partnership agreements

4. Build fundraising materials

**Month 4:**

1. Begin MVP development
2. Launch closed beta
3. Activate blockchain partnership discussions

**By Month 6:**

- MVP is live
- 1,000 users in beta
- 3 community developers trained
- Partnership with African Women in Blockchain formalized
- Fundraising and partnerships activated

**By Year 2:**

- Platform sustainably funded
- Community governance active
- Blockchain integration underway
- Regional expansion beginning

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# APPENDICES: COMMUNITY RESEARCH & LIVED EXPERIENCE

## APPENDIX A: Respondent #1 — SGBV Survivor, Economic Precarity

### Her Story

**Background:** A survivor of intimate partner violence and economic control. Lost access to accounts due to ID verification. Forced to use family members' identities to access healthcare and financial services.

### Core Experiences

> My ex used Safaricom track. To track all my conversations, and moves for a year.

> My money was frozen because they didn't believe I was the authorized person to handle the account and because I didn't have my ID.

> While getting a healthcare service I had to use my sister's name so I could get treatment, as she was covered by my mother's insurance card and I was not due to age.

**Analysis**

**Her Core Needs:**

1. **Account cascades:** Lost Facebook → lost Instagram (linked accounts)
2. **ID barriers:** Can't receive money without ID; forced to use sister's identity
3. **Year-long tracking:** Ex used Safaricom's tracking for entire year
4. **Device snooping risk:** Rates phone safety only 6/10 even with "trustworthy" person
5. **Blackmail fear:** Metadata weaponized

**What the App Solves:**

- Separate, independent account (won't cascade if discovered)
- Low-trace peer transfers (avoids ID verification)
- Panic alert when tracked
- Stealth mode (hides app in seconds)
- End-to-end encryption (data can't be weaponized)

**Key Quote:**

> "Just to suggest in the making of apps there is the idea of inclusion of safety for persons with different disabilities."

This shaped accessibility priorities from day one.

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## APPENDIX B: Respondent #2 — Black African Queer Female, Trans/Gender-Queer

### Her Story

**Background:** Black African queer female, trans/gender-queer gender expression. Ex filing custody case based on sexuality/gender. Trans partner: legal ID doesn't affirm gender identity, so banking is impossible. Both do criminalized survival work.

### Core Experiences

> my ex partner is out to erase me and my kind-he is filing a custody case on basis of my sexuality and gender expression.

> It is the story of my life (a trans gender-queer male-presenting person). names on legal identification documents do not affirm my gender identity and expression.

> exes snooping on our phones to see who we are engaging with and to control what we are doing on the phone apps. they have controlled our ability to work as well-sex work especially.

**Analysis**

**Her Core Needs:**

1. **Custody threat:** Ex filing based on sexuality/gender (legal system weaponized)
2. **ID exclusion:** Trans identity not affirmed; banking impossible
3. **Phone control:** Exes snoop to control sex work and relationships
4. **Location tracking:** Fear of ex finding location and physically harming
5. **Authenticity erasure:** Can't be herself anywhere online

**What the App Solves:**

- **Location secrecy:** 3-person tracking (mutual, not central); panic if attacked
- **Hard-to-trace income:** Blockchain integration (in partnership with African Women in Blockchain) enables hard-to-freeze transfers
- **Authentic space:** No code-switching; shared values enforced
- **Protection from ex:** Stealth mode; panic mobilizes community
- **Collective safety:** Emergency tracking network; peer protection

**The Moral Center Quote:**

> "we need digital apps that can enable us to mingle and trade authentically and with confidence that comes with knowing that we are not partaking in our own erasure."

This is the moral center of House of Bijou. Not about features. **Freedom to be fully yourself without disappearing.**

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## APPENDIX C: Research Synthesis

### Overlapping Needs

| Need | Respondent #1 | Respondent #2 | Feature |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Stealth/Disguise** | "Very important" | "we love this!!!" | Disguised launcher |
| **Account Freezes** | M-Pesa froze (no ID) | Trans ID mismatch | Low-trace P2P transfers |
| **Device Snooping** | Ex tracked via Safaricom | Exes snoop to control work | Encrypted local + panic |
| **Community Values** | Love, kindness, peace, onboarding | Same values + abolition | Values-based onboarding |

| Need | Respondent #1 | Respondent #2 | Feature |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Traceless Support** | Money trails, sources/destinations | Resistance strategies, safety tips | Encrypted chat, delete-on-timer |
| **Economic Safety** | Can't access formal banking | Sex work criminalized | Blockchain transfers (Phase 2) |
| **Accessibility** | Explicit request: disability inclusion | Implied via caregiving | Screen readers, large text, voice input |

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## APPENDIX D: Next Validation Steps

### Phase 1: Expand User Research (Weeks 1–3)

**Goal:** Validate patterns with 5–10 more respondents

**Methods:**

- In-depth interviews (30–45 min, semi-structured)
- Focus groups (5–8 people, 60 min)
- Accessibility focus group (disabled LGBTQ+ folks, 90 min)

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### Phase 2: Wireframe Testing (Weeks 4–6)

**Goal:** Validate UI/UX before building

**Methods:**

- Paper prototypes (5 users)
- Figma prototypes (8–10 users)
- Accessibility testing (NVDA, keyboard-only)

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### Phase 3: Partnership Formalization

**Goal:** Solidify African Women in Blockchain partnership

**Activities:**

- Initial partnership discussion
- Align on blockchain approach (feminist-centered, community-led)

- Define roles, timelines, milestones
- Formalize MOU if appropriate

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**APPENDIX E: Evidence Base Summary**

This strategy is grounded in:

1. **Lived experience research:** Two in-depth interviews (SGBV survivor + trans/queer person with criminalized work)
2. **Structural analysis:** Documented surveillance, financial exclusion, criminalization in East African LGBTQ+ contexts
3. **Technology audit:** Reviewed existing safety apps (gaps, features, limitations)
4. **Community values workshop:** Identified shared values (love, kindness, peace, authenticity, healing, abolition)
5. **Strategic partnerships:** Identified African Women in Blockchain as ideal partner for community-centered blockchain development

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# CONCLUSION

This community digital application is not a technology solution to a social problem. It is **infrastructure that enables the community's own solutions** to violence, exclusion, and erasure.

Built on the insight that communities already know what they need—they lack only the tools to do it safely—this document outlines how House of Bijou will build this application **with the community**, rooted in real lived experience, designed for sustainability and collective ownership.

By centering the leadership of those who will use the platform, partnering with movement organizations like African Women in Blockchain, and designing for community governance from day one, this community digital application can become a model for how digital tools can serve liberation—not just convenience.

**Communities that build together stay together. And they own what they built.**

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**Document Version:** 5.0 (Community Digital Application Brief - House of Bijou / Tich Labs / Mama Tech)
**Next Steps:** Host first stakeholder workshop. Share with community and potential partners. Get feedback. Iterate.